AI PRODUCT CASE STUDY · 2026

Lodestar

Rules do the sorting. The LLM does the judging.

Ekaterina Nikerova
Senior Product Manager · Lisbon
AdTech, ML personalization, e-commerce

7,661
listings collected, 4–7 Nov

4,086
unique vacancies in the same period

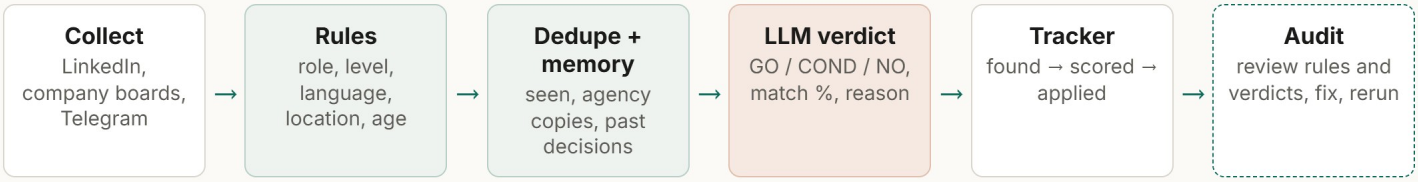
601
LLM evaluations to date (all runs)

11.3%
GO + COND verdicts (68 of 601)

01 · The problem

Fragmented sources, duplicated listings, repeated manual screening and no reliable memory of previous decisions. The same job is reposted by agencies and published in several countries, and it is hard to remember which ones I have already read.

02 · The architecture



Hybrid AI screening pipeline: deterministic filtering + LLM judgment + human feedback loop. Green = code, orange = LLM.

CODE DECIDES

- Product-role titles only; drops Head-of, Director, Technical PM
- Drops vacancies older than 30 days; country and "hires from Europe" checks
- Hard stops: required language, experience level
- Dedupe by company + title + country; the direct employer wins over an agency copy
- Remembers every vacancy seen and hides decided ones
- Batches, parses verdicts, updates the tracker

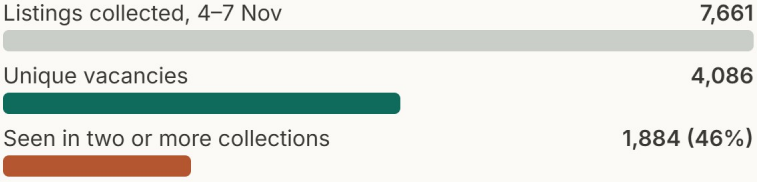
One run, 6 Nov: 1,429 collected → 31 prepared for LLM evaluation. Rules and dedupe removed 84%, memory 13%.

LLM DECIDES

- A Claude Project holds my screening framework and verified facts about my experience
- Does the role fit my background? Which requirements are real blockers?
- Returns a structured answer: verdict, match % and a one-line reason
- The program parses it and attaches it to the vacancy

601 scored: 17 GO, 51 COND, 533 NO. Only vacancies that survive the rules are prepared for the model.

03 · Persistent memory prevents repeated work



Almost half of the unique vacancies came back in a later run. By hand, each one means opening it again and trying to recall the decision. Lodestar recognizes it and shows it once.

04 · What didn't work

Two of my own title rules (anything with "platform" or "lead") were removing roles close to my experience. The LLM was not the cause. I found it by reading what the rules rejected, removed both rules and sent those vacancies back through scoring. **Human review catches systematic filtering errors.**

> **What I took from it:** automation is not about delegating everything to AI. It is about finding where deterministic logic is more reliable, cheaper and easier to audit than an LLM, and keeping the model for judgment.

Python · SQLite · Claude Project · Excel. Built with Claude as a coding assistant; architecture and screening criteria designed by Ekaterina. Estimated time per batch of 20: ~2.5–3 min with Lodestar vs ~2 min per vacancy by hand (my estimates, measurement in progress). In use for my own job search: 40 applications tracked.

GitHub
github.com/EkaterinaN20/lodestar-case
LinkedIn linkedin.com/in/ekaterina-nikerova19